Basics

09 February 2026 08:43

Different phases.

Phase: finding co-conspirators, trying to find people to join the cause. Hiring them or charming them or blackmailing them. Different values of like hate, the more you have them in your grasp the more they either need to be part of it or not. Can execute them or leave them alive, but if they rat you out you have a chance of being ended

Phase: planning. Choosing to kill the emporer, certain ways beget certain bonuses, you can acquire funding to do it in a certain way. Map of imperial palace, parts can be obscured due to building works, not having the plans etc. Get closer to the emporer to be able to do more in planning phase, locking certain doors, replacing certain guards with ones in your post, etc.

Phase: the murder. You can get to see it if you're there, but you may not be able to. If you're there, which increases suspicion, you get to see exactly how people act, if you're not there you have to rely on word of mouth, and plots can be growing or not depending on how you interpret some people's reports.
Then restart. Need to kill certain number of emporers to be crowned yourself.

Forum shadowy circle, where discuss the plot in first phase.
Map of imperial palace in second phase
Reports in third phase

Slay the Spire esque pathing system, path into events.

Between Runs

09 February 2026 08:46

When a plot is failed, book closes over the whole screen, revealing it to be being read to a young, impressionable man. He chooses one of three lessons he's learnt from the book, that leads to upgrades. For example, if a run failed due to a multitude of events - no oversight on the palace map, too much suspicion gained in the political phase, or betrayal of enemies, the child can choose one of these areas to be inspired by, leading to a lasting permenant upgrade, and a stat boost in that area that the next run benefits from. I.E.

No oversight on palace grounds -> ability to bribe architects and workers to reveal plan -> can place a free personal spy in any room to report back on how it went.

Each area can have up to x permenant upgrades, similar to the candles of hope in DD2.

Plotting Phase

09 February 2026 08:49

Political Phase

09 February 2026 08:49

Chance to learn about the Emperor, Co-Conspirators, the state of politics, to utilise these to attempt to build out the plan for the assassination

Different random events that add information to the Emperor Sheet, can give you money or other boons, and can be used to effect public opinion.

Also used to bolster your own political career, making it more likely you would be emperor. Underlying conditions give points to other key figures, who also intersect and are vying for power themselves.

Conspiracy Phase

09 February 2026 08:49

Meeting with co-conspirators. Can influence decisions from the pact, set up the room to influence in what regard you're held, and use this to try to push people in certain directions

The night of the murder

09 February 2026 08:50

The biggest night, so needs good intel to be able to impart any gameplay mechanics. I'm thinking more deckbuilder/management than actual murder, so dice rolls, stats cards etc. We want to have, similarly to spire, a lot of information shown about the results of these boosts, stats etc.

We need to decide a few things - the method, the area, the plan. Each emperor can have their own weaknesses, but these are shown more as intel, the stuff you build up from each assassination should be displayed on a screen with cards: such as

Creature of Habit - They follow a strict routine, and can always be found doing certain things at certain times

Partially blind - they have a blind spot due to blindness in one eye

Take my Wife, please - they have a proclivity to trust women above all else

These should be used to attempt to guide both the political and murder motivations of the player, and each of them should interact to guide what options a player is able to use to plan the murder

So we have

Area: Where they are killed
Method: How they are killed
Conspirators: who you use to kill them
Area Plan: how we set up the scene.

Area plan should be as if chess pieces are set up on a board, a recreation of the event on paper. You can choose, based on your influence, what doors to lock, where to set up spies, who to bribe. These then interact to cause the pathfinding of the emporer to change, how many guards he has and their allegiances to change, and to both determine if you get away with it, and what your position is after the murder, if successful.

If a plot is foiled, there's a chance you're executed based upon the emperors trust in you, what you exploit, and how that impacts if they think you're behind it. You can also have the chance of them becoming closer to you, depending on if you make it out in a way to implicate someone else.

So goal is:

Choose area, and set it up in a way that the Emperor is most likely to path into the kill zone, or away from their guards, or into a trap.

Set up where the conspirators are placed, and bribe members of the guard to attempt to get them on side.

Choose whether you'll be present or not: if you're present you'll learn more and gain more tricks, but you will be more like to be implicated or a target of suspicion

Bonus events

09 February 2026 08:50

Plotting on the Ides is harder but lessens suspicion - emporers are more prepared and on guard, but the omen makes it so less aspersions are put on the co-conspirator

Honorifics

09 February 2026 11:38

Some events and perceived public ratings can give you honorifics, that effect public sway and how you are perceived in the world

Eg If you take an event by which you cheat at a game, you may be known as a cheater, which then influences the people you may meet and what they'll require to be made a co-conspirator.

You may need to lose a gambling match with them/give them a lot of money to prove your worth, or get more people approach you with a similar trait.

Courses

09 February 2026 08:44

https://www.udemy.com/course/godot-4-build-launch-full-2d-roguelike-game/

Godot 4 Intermediate Card Game Course



Systems

09 February 2026 12:13

Stats

09 February 2026 11:53

PC:
Personal
Honorific
Military
Political
Economical
Personal
Virtue
Age
Health
Public Support

Public Relations: (Apply to Rome as a Whole)
Likeability
Trust
Suspicion
Virtue

Senate Relations: (Apply to the Senate as a Whole)
Likeability
Trust
Suspicion
Virtue

Interpersonal: (Apply to other NPCs)
Likeability
Gullibility
Trust
Suspicion

Emperor:
Honorific
Military
Political
Economical
Personal
Virtue
Age
Health
Traits & Ailments
Public Support

Areas

09 February 2026 12:03

Banquet
Feast
Private Dinner
Imperial Palace
Colosseum
Gardens
Speech
Public Outing
Military Battle
Streets

Events

09 February 2026 12:13

Campaigns

09 February 2026 12:13

Campaigns influence

Propaganda Campaigns

09 February 2026 12:16

These are campaigns that can be used to influence your relationship with the Public or the Senate, they cost gold, and can have effects based upon your honorifics, your other stats, and how the public perceive you

1. Variables

17 February 2026 07:55

Execute the Emperor is a resource management game primarily, in which you attempt to gain the gold, favour and access needed to kill the emperor without being suspected. The game is a deckbuilder at heart, using cards to impart information or determine player actions, and will also involve some level of pathing.

The gameplay will be primarily revolving around managing a set of global and local variables, Global being variables that apply to the player, and can be contributed to by any source, and local variables being those that apply to the player, or to NPCs, and can be contributed to by only the player or NPCs. These variables will relate to interpersonal relationships, or player attributes - for example a Co-Conspirator will have different variables relating to how they feel about the player, and examples may be:

- Happiness
- Suspicion
- Gullibility (how much they think they can get away with lying to you)

The player has their own variables, such as

- Money
- Influence
- Charm
- Military
- Political

The Emperor also has many of the same variables as co-conspirators, but also have special variables that relate to how much they take notice of the player, and how the Emperor's standing is with the people, such as

- Notice (of the player)
- Influence
- Money
- Happiness
- Suspicion
- Military
- Senate Relationship
- Public relationship

Finally, the most important global variable is Pressure, which acts as a meta variable that defines the course of the game, and is an important win or lose condition.

All variables, per either NPC or per globally, will be ranked out of 100, and should be distributed at average being around the 50 mark, with 100 being perfect, and 0 being abysmal. These variables should interact with each other, I.E. increased happiness should decrease suspicion generally, though a co-conspirator could be happy with you though also find you suspicious. Broadly global variables should have a set relationship: your money should positively correlate with influence in every run - but certain co-conspirators may have different relationships between variables, defined by the traits of the co-conspirators.

For example, a socialite co-conspirator may positively correlate with your charm, but negatively correlate with your militarism. As you grow a socialite's happiness, they may also find you more gullible, and may spin yarns or lie to you about certain effects. If another co-conspirator is a military

man, your charm may inversely effect their happiness, so you need to balance how you grow and influence certain variables.

Traits of certain co-conspirators should be revealed to the player, so that the player can make educated choices. Do you increase your charm, appeasing a socialite, at the cost of a military man? This mechanism should both promote synergy in the plot, while also interjecting a level of risk and management as the player eventually is forced to draft a wide pool of co-conspirators, managing their happiness as the game proceeds.

1.1 Pressure

17 February 2026 09:30

Pressure acts as the global catalyst for the game, and will both positively and negatively affect the outcome space for the game. Pressure can be seen as the metavariable that pushes the player towards planning the assassination - players will have the freedom to choose when to go ahead with the assassination, but pressure acts as a mechanism that forces action, both carrot and stick.

Increased pressure allows for better co-conspirators to be drafted, it creates more opportunities to raise certain stats, but as the pressure mounts so too will negative effects. For example, as pressure gets higher, certain co-conspirators may force their way into the group, blackmailing you unless you appease them. They may want money, or charm, or force cards into your hand that are of less use to you, else they'll spill the beans.

Conversely, low pressure means fewer opportunities. With low pressure, the Emperor may be in good standing, and co-conspirators may have higher costs to draft. Why join in a treacherous plot, when the empire is doing so well?

Pressure therefore acts as the pressure for the player to continue the plot, the pressure on the emperor and his position, the pressure to act expediently. You want to manage your pressure well, grow it at a reasonable pace, and allow the positive effects to be present while managing the drawbacks.

Critically, it is *very hard* to remove or reduce pressure, but *easy* to gain it. Pressure will be incremented very slowly with every action in the game - each turn should add 1 pressure, such that the clock ticks up as the game progresses. Certain cards or events will add pressure by chance, and certain powerful cards or co-conspirators will also increase the pressure by player choice. For example, making a speech that denounces an emperors policy may increment the pressure by 5, whilst also increasing your influence and the emperors suspicion. Co-conspirators may also bring passive pressure gain, increasing the rate at which pressure increases. But pressure is sticky upwards, there should be *no more than a handful* of effects that can stall or reduce pressure.

This acts as a 'time bomb' in each run, that forces player action, while also having some positive effects. Because it is hard to remove, it should make each run feel like a snowball, creating cascading consequences that help the player, while also mounting the IRL pressure the PC feels to complete their quest.

If pressure hits 100, unless very certain circumstances are met, this should be seen as more or less a lose condition. The player will want to choose to begin the assassination well before that point. Once pressure hits ~80, it should be that no matter what, the pressure will be expected to snowball into 100 very soon.
If pressure hits 100, the assassination will continue more or less on autopilot - it can still result in a win, but by this point the plot is truly out of the player's hands - someone will make a move. I want this to feel similarly to losing power in five nights at freddy's - when you see the face of the animatronic as the power goes off and you hope that you've hit 6am. Sure, you can win - but the chances are against you, you've lost your influence, lost the plot, and you just need to hope that the chances are in your favour.

Though for earlier drafts of the game we should stick to one assassination, the end goal is for there to be many assassinations, each one having a different emperor take the throne if your own stats and favour isn't such that you'd be made emperor. In this case, this would be one mechanism for the pressure to reduce (but not fully). We will leave this til future drafts.

2. The Player Character

17 February 2026 11:59

3. Co-Conspirators

17 February 2026 11:59

Co-Conspirators are the driving force of the game, and are the driving force behind the game. Co-Conspirators are a type of card that both improve certain stats, unlock new areas and abilities, allow for further in-game events and interactions, and help bolster the position of the plot.

Each Co-Conspirator will need to be drafted from a selection, this selection pool will persist between rounds, with certain co-conspirators being added or removed from the pool as the game continues. For example, you may have 3 initial co-conspirators available to draft, but as you improve stats, trigger certain pressure thresholds, or make a decision in an in-game event, another co-conspirator may open up as an option. Similarly, progression may cause a possible co-conspirator to lose interest, causing them to disappear from the draft pool.

Co-conspirators should largely become available dependant upon the stats you currently have. One that is military focused may require a military floor to trigger, a better military man may need a higher floor, but if you surpass that floor then they may no longer be available. There will also be a relationship between pressure and co-conspirators: in general better co-conspirators will be available the greater the pressure, up to a point. Pressure that is too great may cause unstable or unreliable co-conspirators to spawn, and so on.

Co-Conspirators will cost an amount to draft, being either a minimum requirement, or costing a reduction in a variable stat. One may join willingly if your charm is high enough, one may actually cost you charm to acquire. Say a conspirator is known for being a lout, or a womaniser, then you can choose to *pay* influence to hire them, actively reducing this score, in return for a co-conspirator.

Some may cost money, some may join without your consent, especially as the pressure rises. You may also choose to blackmail a co-conspirator, spending money and pressure to force them on side, at a cost of their reduced happiness, greater suspicion, and mounting pressure. But what do they actually do?

3.1 The Effect of Co-Conspirators on Stats

17 February 2026 12:09

Co-Conspirators will always have an influence on your stats. Each one will come with their own standing and variables, and these will increment onto your adjusted base variables to improve or worsen certain stats. A Co-Conspirator who is incredibly influential will increase your influence by a certain amount, creating greater opportunities for influence rolls. Similarly to Call of Chthulu, the chance of passing or failing checks is directly tied to your variables: an influence stat of 70 means that a d100 is rolled, and if your score is smaller than or equal to your influence, you pass this check.

3.2 Co-Conspirator Skills

17 February 2026 12:12

Each co-conspirator will also contribute cards and abilities to the day to day of public life, each coming with their own cards that can be drawn and used. Importantly, you cannot add or remove cards corresponding to a co-conspirator, you may only add or remove co-conspirators. Each co-conspirator comes with their own cards that will be absorbed into your pools, and these can be positive or negative (think curses in slay the spire for example).

Whenever an event or action occurs, cards will be drawn out of the pool that correlates to it. For example, an event may require a military card to be played, so your total card pool that will be drawn will be from the military cards from the combined pool of yours and your co-conspirators. Other events may allow combinations of cards, which will be indicated in advance.

Co-Conspirators may also allow for one time use cards, usable outside of events. One may allow for a propaganda campaign to be used, costing an amount of money and increasing pressure in return for boosting one of your stats. Co-conspirators become happier when you use their cards, and so there is a trade-off between using a net negative card to keep a conspirator happy. The more you refuse to use conspirator cards, the more unhappy they get. Overusing one conspirator's card may also cause other conspirators to become suspicious of you, and so on.

3.3 Co-Conspirator Areas

17 February 2026 12:17

Co-Conspirators also will have access to certain areas to plot the assassination. Throughout the course of the game, you will learn information about the emperor: Where they go for walks, their routine, their favourite drinks. You will therefore need to choose co-conspirators that will afford opportunity to utilise the information you have learnt about the emperor to improve your chances of getting the kill.

For example:

You have learnt through the course of the game that the emperor enjoys the company of actors, that he spends his evenings at the palace heavily guarded with the praetorian guard, but that at night he covertly goes to watch plays, indulge in wine, and tries to remain unseen. You therefore have a few things you want to make sure you can use to plot the assassination:

1. Area. You need a co-conspirator who has access to the area of the playhouse
2. Access. You need co-conspirator who fraternises with actors
3. Murder weapon. You may want a co-conspirator who can sufficiently get access to poisons, to poison his wine

Alternatively:

1. Area. You may want a co-conspirator who has access to the imperial palace
2. Access: You may want a co-conspirator who has contact with members of the praetorian guard
3. Wealth: You may want a co-conspirator with a lot of money, who can bribe members of the guard to turn the other way, or even kill the emperor

As your knowledge of the emperor builds, you will begin to understand that certain co-conspirators are the best choice for attempting to plot the assassination, but as they are 'sticky', and hard to get rid of once they understand the plot, this may go against the team you have already built up, by the time more info is revealed.

If you build a deck with a lot of military men, only to uncover that the Emperor does not often go on military conquests, or that the price in that area of hiring military men is too great, then you may need to pivot to the poisoning at the theatre route. This could cause conflict within the plot: if military men do not get along with the acting types, then you need to carefully manage your pivot, all the while pressure grows and discord is sown. Having an understanding of the privileges certain co-conspirators afford you is useful, but things may shift and change. You may even have the ability to try to sow seeds of ideas into the emperors head as you go. Do you use your skills and co-conspirators to lead the Emperor down a path that suits you, or do you change your group of co-conspirators to fit the Emperor's habits?

3.4 Removing Co-Conspirators

17 February 2026 17:05

Co-Conspirators should be very sticky - once they are in your party it is very unlikely you'll be able to remove them. The reason for this is twofold: it would canon be very risky to have a co-conspirator, they would want to extract as much value out of you as possible if you were to drop them - them knowing your plans and being able to extract a good price.

Secondly, it should be tricky because the player should be playing around the negative interactions between co-conspirators, rather than simply chopping and thinning to make a collection of co-conspirators that will synergise well.

Only a select few events or cards should be allow the player to trim their co-conspirators, and all at a great cost. Generally, some co-conspirators may have an ability to remove another, by paying off (at cost to the player's funds), by charming, etc. It may also be allowed to have a player kill a co-conspirator, available at all points, but this should strongly strongly be deterred, coming at great cost of suspicion from other co-conspirators, and worsened stats. It should be an ability that could reasonably only be done once ever in a run, when absolutely necessary

4. The Emperor

17 February 2026 17:11

The Emperor is the objective of the game, and as such is the primary source of the game's interactions. All decisions made by a player should either aid the player's own position, or aid the goal of assassinating the emperor. As with most things in the game, these should be in tension, it should not often be the case that a larger choice (like hiring a co-conspirator) can immediately, at base, both improve the player's standing and gain them a foothold with the emperor. In the early game this is to be expected, as most things will be of aid - but as the player gets into the midgame and beyond, it should be rare for any decision to be immediately beneficial with no downsides.

Of course, playing well should reward the player - its just that these rewards should be born out of the interactions with the game systems the player has already, not from a base 'This card is good'.

So, how do we find out about the Emperor?

4.1 Emperor Stats

17 February 2026 17:15

4.2 Emperor Traits

17 February 2026 17:16

4.3 Emperor Tendencies

17 February 2026 17:16

4.4 The Emperor Stat Sheet

17 February 2026 17:16

5. The Gameplay Loop

17 February 2026 17:23

The game should have a selection of pathing, slay the spire type bits to try to choose the upcoming events. There shouldn't be a full path, but instead some slight foresight, maybe improved by co-conspirators or events